

Subject: Proposal to Enhance Student Hiring Support / New Graduate Hiring Support by Enabling Direct Transfers to Students/ New Hires
From: aks <aks@betaori.com>
Date: 2026-01-27, 1:01 p.m.
To: shafqat.ali@parl.gc.ca

Dear Honourable Shafqat Ali,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to respectfully propose a targeted enhancement to the Student Work Placement Program (SWPP) specifically, to introduce a provision that would allow approved startups to facilitate direct financial transfers to post-secondary students, provided they submit verifiable evidence of the student's contribution and logged work hours.

As you know, the SWPP provides vital wage subsidies (up to \$5000 per student, and up to \$7000 for students from under represented groups or in their first year of study) to help employers offset the cost of hiring students. This initiative has already proven mutually beneficial for both employers and students across Canada.

However, many early-stage startups particularly those operating with constrained cash flow or lacking formal payroll infrastructure face practical barriers in accessing or administering these subsidies through traditional disbursement models. The requirement to pay students upfront and then seek reimbursement can be a significant hurdle, even when full subsidy eligibility is assured.

To address this, I propose modifying the program to allow a portion of the wage subsidy to be transferred directly to the student's account, upon validation of logged work hours and deliverables submitted jointly by the startup and the student peer reviewed by the university placement officer. This would:

- reduce administrative and financial burden on startups, enabling more of them to participate;
- improve transparency and accountability, as work logs and milestone submissions would be formally documented;
- accelerate student access to income, particularly benefiting those from underrepresented or financially vulnerable backgrounds;
- encourage greater startup participation, expanding experiential learning opportunities in Canada's innovation economy.

Startups would still be required to meet all current SWPP eligibility criteria, including providing meaningful work experiences and ensuring proper mentorship. The direct-transfer option would be optional and subject to verification through the existing funding recipients

Given Canada's strong commitment to youth employment, inclusive innovation, and startup growth. This refinement could significantly amplify the program's impact especially in high-potential sectors like clean tech, AI, and digital health, where students talent is critical. This approach could also be extended to new graduates who seek employment, while for new graduates, we could either work with university or with employment agency like YMCA or Center for Skills Development or Achev.

Thank you for your leadership and for considering this proposal. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss it further or provide additional details at your convenience.

Sincerely,
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